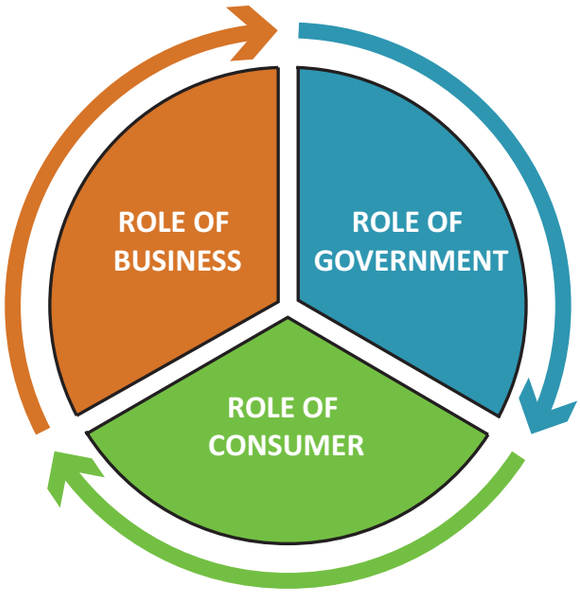
Self-regulation, Consumer Associations, Alert consumer, and State Support are some of the means of consumer protection. Individual consumer is considered more vulnerable, in the modern world, to exploitation and harassment by the manufacturers and distributors or sellers because of environmental complexities of business operations, technological changes, application of mass production techniques, vast resources, man-power and acrimonious advertising, Hence it is necessary to protect and promote the consumer interest. Satisfaction and well being of the consumer should be the main objective of all business units. In real practice, consumer is not protected or safeguarded but, consumer is cheated and looted. Thus, there is a need for consumer movement to safeguard their interest.

16.07 Need for Consumer Protection



Though consumer is said to be the king of entire business sphere, his interests are virtually neglected. Shortage of goods makes the consumers to be content with whatever is offered for sale. Quality is sacrificed: warranty of performance has no meaning; health hazard is never considered; profit maximisation turns out to be sole consideration of business enterprises. In such a context, consumer protection remains a vital importance.

There are three parties involved in the sphere of business transactions viz. the Government, business and the consumers. Let us discuss what each party has to do in this regard



Role of Business

Business enterprises should do the following towards protecting consumers.

1. Avoidance of Price Hike

Business enterprises should desist from hiking the price in the context of acute shortage of goods /articles.

2. Avoidance of Hoarding

Business enterprises should allow the business to flow normally. It should not indulge in hoarding and black marketing to earn maximum possible profit in the short term at the cost of consumers.

3. Guarantees for Good Quality

Business enterprises should not give false warranty for the products. It should ensure supply of good quality.

4. Product Information

Business enterprises should disclose correct, complete and accurate information about the product viz. size, quality, quantity, substances, use, side effects, precautions, weight, exchange, mode of application etc.

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